

ESSENTIAL

Document Checklist by Applicant Type

Self-funded - Family-funded - Loan-funded - Scholarship/Sponsored - With family

Every applicant needs

- Your Letter of Acceptance from your DLI, with its DLI number
- Your Provincial/Territorial Attestation Letter (PAL), if your situation requires one
- Valid passport or travel document
- Financial evidence meeting the cost-of-living formula (see the Financial Requirements Overview)
- A written study plan (see the Study Plan Templates, Complete tier)
- Academic transcripts or language test results your Letter of Acceptance was conditional on

If you're self-funding

- Personal bank statements showing the required amount, covering a reasonable recent period
- A Guaranteed Investment Certificate (GIC) from a participating Canadian financial institution is one commonly accepted way to evidence living costs specifically

If a parent or relative is funding you

- Their bank statements or financial evidence showing the required amount
- A letter confirming the relationship and their commitment to fund your studies - see the Sponsor & Financial Letter Templates (Complete tier)

If you have a student/education loan

- An official loan approval letter from the lending institution, stating the amount and that it's available for your studies

If you're sponsored by a government or institutional scholarship

- An official confirmation/sponsorship letter from the sponsoring body, covering fees and/or living costs as applicable
- If the sponsorship only covers part of the cost, you'll still need to evidence the remainder yourself

If you're under the custodianship age for your destination province

MINOR APPLICANTS

Provinces set their own age thresholds (commonly 17 or 18) below which a study permit applicant needs a custodianship arrangement - a designated adult in Canada responsible for your care and living arrangements while you study. Check your specific destination province's requirement and your DLI's custodianship process if this applies to you.

If you're bringing accompanying family members

- Additional financial evidence covering their living costs too - see the Financial Planning Calculator (Premium tier), which accounts for each additional family member
- Their own supporting documents (relationship evidence, passports) as part of the combined application